



ORGANISATION INTERNATIONALE
DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

BUREAU INTERNATIONAL DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE
OF LEGAL METROLOGY

TWENTY-SIXTH MEETING
PARIS - 7th to 9th October 1991

MINUTES

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TWENTY-SIXTH MEETING
OF THE
INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE OF LEGAL METROLOGY
Paris, 7th to 9th October 1991

The International Committee of Legal Metrology was convened by its President, Mr K. BIRKELAND, and met in Paris in the conference room of the Office International des Épizooties from Monday 7th to Wednesday 9th October 1991.

ATTENDANCE

The following persons were present:

Australia	: J. BIRCH	Member, CIML
Austria	: R. GALLE	Member, CIML
Belgium	: H. VOORHOF	Member, CIML
Brazil	: G. MOSCATI M.C. FAGUNDES L. CONTIER DE FREITAS (Mrs)	
Bulgaria	: V. GAVRAILOV S. SIMEONOV	Member, CIML
Cameroon	: S. NOUMSI	Member, CIML
Canada	: R.G. KNAPP	Member, CIML
P.R. of China	: BAI JINGZHONG FENG LIMING	Member, CIML
Cuba	: L. REVUELTA FORMOSO	
Cyprus	: G. TSIARTZAZIS	Member, CIML
Czechoslovakia	: A. KURUC J. SYNAC M. CIBAK	Member, CIML
Denmark	: O. PETERSEN	Member, CIML
Finlande	: U. LÄHTEENMÄKI (Mrs)	Member, CIML
France	: J. HUGOUNET	Member, CIML
Germany	: M. KOCHSIEK : K. BRINKMANN : W. GÖGGE	V/President, CIML
Greece	: J. KAPONIKOLOS	
Hungary	: D. BELEDI P. PAKAY	Member, CIML
Indonesia	: G.M. PUTERA	Member, CIML
Ireland	: P. FARRAGHER	
Italy	: C. AMODEO	Member, CIML
Japan	: S. HATTORI : YOKO de MONTESSU (Mrs)	Member, CIML

Kenya	: P.A. AYATA	Member, CIML
R. of Korea	: LIM BYUNG-JU NAM KI-CHUL	Member, CIML
Monaco	: A. VEGLIA	Member, CIML
Netherlands	: J.A.J. BASTEN J.G. TUINDER	Member, CIML
Norway	: K. BIRKELAND K. LINDLØV	Président, CIML
Poland	: Z. REFEROWKI	Member, CIML
Portugal	: M. VICENTE J.N. CARTAXO REIS	Member, CIML
Rumania	: D. STOICHITOIU I. ANDREAS (Mrs)	Member, CIML
Saudi Arabia	: M. AIYASH	
Spain	: J.L. MANCHADO	
Sweden	: R. OHLON	Member, CIML
Switzerland	: J.M. VIRIEUX	
Tanzania	: A.H.M. TUKAI	Member, CIML
United Kingdom	: S.J. BENNETT	Member, CIML
United States of America	: S.E. CHAPPELL H.E. SOSTMANN	V/President, CIML
U.S.S.R.	: V.I. PUSTOVOIT	Member, CIML
Yugoslavia	: M. EZOV Z.M. MARKOVIC	Member, CIML

International Bureau of Legal Metrology:

B. ATHANÉ
S.A. THULIN
A. VICHENKOV
W.H. EMERSON
E. WEBER

Delegated votes:

P.D.R. of Korea to P.R. of China
India to Germany.

Note: The delegation of Ethiopia's vote to Morocco took no effect because the latter was not represented.

Apologies:

Egypt, Ethiopia, Israel, Morocco, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Tunisia.

States not having nominated a Committee Member:

Algeria, Lebanon.

OPENING ADDRESS

by K. BIRKELAND, President of the Committee

Ladies and Gentlemen, dear Colleagues,

These first years of the current decade have brought a number of surprises. In Oporto last year a reunited Germany was represented by a single delegation led by Professor Kochsiek. In Paris this year Professor Pustovoit no longer represents quite the same USSR as before, even though, according to my most recent information, it would seem that metrology will continue to be dealt with centrally within the new Union, and not at Republican level. There have been important political and economic changes in Poland, Czechoslovakia, Hungary, Bulgaria, and Rumania. Other Member States, and now I am thinking particularly of Ethiopia and Yugoslavia, have experienced difficult and even tragic circumstances, and with all my heart I wish that they may again walk the paths of peace.

We must of course do all we can to protect OIML from such world-shaking events. We belong to a purely technical organization which has hitherto succeeded in avoiding the effects of international dissention and antagonisms, and I hope that it will always be so in the future. But at the same time we cannot shut our eyes and pretend that we live in an unchanging world. The events that I have just mentioned will certainly have repercussions, whether good or bad, on our activities. We must think about them and try to predict them so that we can recoup the benefits and minimize the disadvantages.

After this introduction dictated by current events I would like, dear Colleagues, to refer more directly to our meeting and of course I will begin by saying how pleased I am to see so many of you here at the opening of the twenty-sixth meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology.

I had the pleasure of meeting some of you last week at the General Conference on Weights and Measures; to you and to all the others who are in Paris especially for this meeting I extend the warmest of welcomes and hope that your stay in Paris will be a pleasant one. For various reasons some of our Members are not able to be present; some are currently in Madrid for the first world summit for standardization, organized jointly by ISO and IEC; such is the richness of this month of October in events concerning international technical co-operation.

Before coming to the various items that we are going to have to discuss I would like to make the traditional references to the changes that have taken place in the composition of our Committee. They concern Bulgaria, the Republic of Korea, France and Czechoslovakia, who are now respectively represented by Mr Gavrilov, Mr Lim Byung-Ju, Mr Hugounet and Mr Kuruc in place of Mr Tzarevski, Mr Son Bock-Gill, Mr Bertran and Mr Cibák. Welcome to you all, you four new Members of CIML.

I must also report two deaths.

First that of our former President, Doctor Joseph Stulla-Götz. That eminent personality, President of the Austrian Bundesamt für Eich- und Vermessungswesen, member of a number of international institutions, chaired the International Committee of Legal Metrology from 1962 to 1968; he had a vital influence on OIML's development.

The other is more recent: it happened hardly more than a few days ago; it is of Professor Moser. He represented the Federal Republic of Germany at our Organization from 1961 to 1969 and was a member of the Presidential Council.

I would ask you to observe a moment's silence in their memory.

Thank you.

Let us turn now to our agenda and to the various subjects of our discussions, or at least to the most important of them, and first of all to the principles and methods of OIML's work.

Our ways of working, that is mainly the aims that we set ourselves and the methods and means that we give ourselves to achieve them, are none of them immutable. We live in a changing world; legal metrology is changing, and OIML must adapt itself to those changes, or even try to anticipate them to be able to give an immediate response to new needs from the moment that they appear.

As I said in the opening sentences of this address, some of our Member States are undergoing fundamental changes, which will certainly have repercussions within OIML's activities.

However I am not worried about the extent of those repercussions. It is imaginable that some of those countries will align themselves with the free economies that are to be found in many other countries, and that their concepts of legal metrology, rigidly state controlled and applying to all measurement, will probably evolve towards a more restricted, less systematic application based on trade, safety, health and the protection of the environment.

OIML will thus be less divided between two tendencies and will be better placed to concentrate its activities on matters that are of interest to a much larger majority of its Member States.

But there is another tendency that could have much greater consequences for the Organization; I refer to the development of regional and multinational co-operation that is of increasing importance.

It is of course in Europe that regional co-operation is developing the most rapidly, in the general field of metrology and in legal metrology in particular.

The twelve countries of the European Community have only fourteen months to develop the Directives or Directive and the accompanying European standards to establish a real single market for measuring instruments, while the Community Reference Bureau pursues its comparisons of measurement standards and calibration methods and its research into methods of measurement. The five EFTA countries have decided to adopt the Community's regulations. The three organizations, EUROMET, WECC and WELMEC, that bring together almost all of those seventeen countries, organize flexible cooperation in the fields of scientific metrology, calibration and legal metrology.

CEN and CENELEC have started developing standards on matters that concern legal metrology: gas meters, taxi meters, water meters, without waiting for a mandate from the European Commission.

The European countries that were formerly called "eastern" or "socialist" are reorganizing their metrological cooperation within COOMET following the demise of COMECON, and intend to establish links with EUROMET, WECC and WELMEC.

But other centres of cooperation are developing in other regions of the world. Recently I was in the USA to attend the National Conference of Standards Laboratories which, despite being described as "national", in fact brings together several countries. Legal metrology had its place there, in particular in a contribution from our Vice-President Sam Chappell on the new forms of metrological control by self-certification by the manufacturer.

In the Pacific, Asia and Africa, as well as in the Arab countries - even if ASMO's activities seem to have been brought to a halt by the Gulf war - regional action is beginning or continuing.

What can the consequences of these movements be for OIML? I can foresee two eventualities.

Either OIML will be able to maintain its international leadership in matters of legal metrology and remain the sole world institution recognized in the field: it will then be able to co-operate as much with countries individually as with the regional organizations that I mentioned earlier, and its mission of unifying the regulation of legal metrology and the relevant control procedures will be harmoniously accomplished.

Or OIML's leadership will not be recognized; regional work will then develop without links or coordination between them, with possible divergences and therefore the appearance of new technical barriers to trade, with the added possibility that progress in one region may be more rapid than in others, thus giving to that region the leadership that has been lost to OIML.

How can the second eventuality, which I hope none of you would wish to be realized, be prevented?

By redefining our programme of activities, by improving our working methods, and by developing our certificate system.

Redefining our programme of activities

We must concentrate our activities on matters that are specifically in the domain of legal metrology, that is on those that concern instruments likely to be the object of technical barriers to trade arising from differing national or regional regulations, and for which it is necessary to establish international requirements of performance by reason of their use in fields that affect the essential matters of trade, health, safety or the preservation of the environment. OIML is not a standards organization set up to produce standards for any measuring instrument, just for the simple reason that it is a measuring instrument. OIML has as its aim the resolution internationally of problems arising from the fact that certain categories of instruments are subject to legal control. The more specific our activities, the more credible will they be and the more acceptable will be our monopoly.

Improve our working methods

In the specific fields of our activities we shall have to produce better Recommendations more quickly.

It is not acceptable that countries develop their own new regulations because OIML has not been able to produce the corresponding Recommendations in sufficient time.

It is not acceptable that, after a draft has been accepted by a reporting secretariat, two or perhaps three years should elapse before the agreement of the pilot secretariat, and then of the Committee, is obtained.

It is not acceptable that a reporting secretariat should work for several years and that the result should then be rejected by the Committee because of poor quality or lack of international interest, or because it conflicts with other specifications that already have international recognition.

We must find ways of working that provide both excellent technical quality and a broad international participation in the development of drafts that can be approved quickly by the Committee, without extending the time scale and even, if possible, shortening it. We must also make sure that the work is done with the full participation of the interested parties.

Develop our certificate system

Our Recommendations are meant to be applied by our Member States. What better proof of an effective application than the real operation of a certificate system such as that which we have just launched? Of course I mean by "real operation" not only the issuing of certificates, but also and especially their recognition and acceptance to accelerate and simplify the issuing of national and regional pattern approvals.

But on the other hand the development of this system will oblige us, under pressure from manufacturers and national services, to increase the number of applicable Recommendations.

I am convinced that the OIML certificate system is both necessary to our future and a unique opportunity to improve the quality of our work.

Those, dear friends, are the main points that we shall have to discuss at our meeting. But that does not mean that there are not other important matters on the agenda: the approval of draft Recommendations, the situations of the developing countries, elections of a Vice-President of the Committee and of an Assistant to the Director of the Bureau, and many other items, will together comprise the subjects of our thoughts, and I thank you in advance for your active participation in our discussions.

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Roll call - Quorum

Following the opening address the roll of delegates was called. It was established that 40 Members of the Committee were present out of a total of 47. The quorum of three quarters was thus attained.

Approval of the agenda

The Committee approved the following agenda:

- 1 Approval of the minutes of the twenty-fifth meeting of the Committee
 - 2 Member States and Corresponding Members
 - 2.1 New members - Prospective new members
 - 2.2 The situations of some Member States
 - 3 Financial situation
 - 3.1 Approval of the auditor's report for 1990
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 - 14.3 Relations between OIML and the industries manufacturing measuring instruments
 - 15 Date and place of next meeting
- Decisions and Resolutions

MINUTES

1 APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE TWENTY-FIFTH MEETING OF THE COMMITTEE

The minutes were approved without change.

2 MEMBER STATES AND CORRESPONDING MEMBERS

2.1 New members - Prospective new members

Mr ATHANÉ reminded Members that a delegation from the Republic of South Africa had visited the Bureau to enquire about joining OIML, but since then there had been no further news from them. Iran had asked the bureau on what conditions she might rejoin. The Mexican delegation at the General Conference on Weights and Measures had indicated that his country was considering the possibility of becoming a Member State of OIML (it is currently a Corresponding Member); the Argentinean delegation had indicated its country's interest in becoming a Corresponding Member.

Mr ATHANÉ added that Haiti had been accepted as a Corresponding Member but had not paid its annual subscription, so that its membership was in suspense; whereas Yemen had paid a year's subscription but had not applied officially to join as a Corresponding Member.

2.2 The situations of some Member States

Mr ATHANÉ said that Cameroon was the only Member State that was in arrears in its subscriptions to OIML by more than the three years allowed by the Convention. However, as Mr NOUMSI had given his assurance that part of the arrears would be paid quickly, no measures against that country were called for. Mr ATHANÉ also indicated that he had contacted the Lebanese embassy in Paris to ask it to consider its country's position with regard to its membership of OIML.

3 FINANCIAL SITUATION

3.1 Approval of the auditor's report for 1990

The auditor's report was approved without comment.

3.2 The financial situation for 1991 and 1992

Mr ATHANÉ said that the financial estimates sent out at the end of 1990 remained current; in particular the rate of inflation in France was still slightly below the figure of 3.5 % assumed in the estimates. He added that the estimates for 1992 would be sent to CIML Members in about two months and that they would be more or less in line with the budget voted by the Conference in 1988.

Replying to Mr PETERSEN, Mr ATHANÉ said that the redecoration of the building in the rue Turgot was complete except for the three offices on the ground floor, and they should be done at the beginning of 1992. The Bureau was now well equipped with microcomputers; future expenditure in that regard would no longer be considered as "exceptional expenses". The equipment for offset printing, photocopying and telefax had recently been brought up to date.

Mr ATHANÉ also said that the receipt of contributions from Member States was currently satisfactory, but he expressed some disquiet for the future because of the political instabilities in some Member States. Mr BIRKELAND reminded his colleagues that it was their responsibility to see that their administrations paid their contributions to OIML on time.

4 STAFF OF THE BUREAU

4.1 Replacement of a Director's Assistant retiring from the Bureau in September 1992

Mr BIRKELAND reminded Members that Mr Thulin would retire in September 1992 and that the Committee would therefore have to appoint his successor. Three Member States had put forward four candidates for the post:

- Belgium: Mr P. Degavre;
- the People's Republic of China: Mr Dai Runsheng and Mr Wen Shanlin;
- Rumania: Mrs I. Andreas.

Mr Degavre obtained 22 of the 40 votes cast in the first round of a secret ballot, and was thus appointed Director's Assistant, to take up his duties on or about 1st October 1992. (The actual date would be a decision of the Belgian authorities, the interested party, and the Director of the Bureau.)

4.2 Other matters

Mr ATHANÉ informed the Committee of the general staffing position in the Bureau, and in particular of the pending retirement of Mr Emerson in April 1992; his successor would be appointed later by Mr Birkeland by agreement with Mr Athané (since only the nominations of the Director and his Assistants were the prerogative of the Committee); the Director had already contacted certain English-speaking Member States with a view to seeking candidates.

5 CERTIFICATION

5.1 Operation of the OIML Certificate System

Mr BIRKELAND stressed the importance of this subject for OIML and the interest that the OIML System had already aroused among manufacturers of measuring instruments, other international institutions, etc. At his request Mr ATHANÉ spoke about what the Bureau had done to promote the System and get it under way:

- the final production and the very wide distribution of the basic text (available in French and English) on the System; in particular it had been sent to the many international and regional institutions concerned; the publication by ISO in one of its information bulletins on the subject had led to many requests for information;
- the production and very wide distribution of a leaflet (available in French, English and German) summarizing the way in which the System operated and aimed principally at manufacturers and test houses;
- the compilation of information provided by Member States about the appointment of issuing authorities and the preparation of a brochure on the subject;

- the publishing of information about the System periodically in the Bulletin;
- the compilation and distribution of information about actions at national level taken by some Members of the Committee to promote the System.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that the Bureau had done all it could to develop the System but thought that, even more than the Bureau, the Member States could contribute to its promotion, and he asked the Members of the Committee to reveal what they had been able to accomplish at their level. In particular he hoped that the issue of the first certificates was well under way and that those certificates would then be recognized by the other Member States.

Mr PETERSEN indicated that there was slow but steady progress in Denmark in putting the System into operation; obviously OIML had to increase the number of Recommendations to which the System was applicable to encourage its development; in Denmark, as in many other countries, there was a single issuing authority, but in the future there would doubtless be a diversification of authorities, though always under the control of the CIML Member.

Mr BIRCH found the progress made by the System impressive, but he recognized that in Australia there was perhaps a measure of confusion on the part of the manufacturers about the distinction between issuing authorities and test laboratories; could it be made clear when the issuing authority would also be the test laboratory, and when the tests would be performed by bodies other than the issuing authority?

Mr ATHANÉ said that it was perhaps difficult to reply to that question because the issuing authorities were completely free in their choice of test laboratories, provided that the latter satisfied the conditions laid down in the basic text of the System; in a particular country the list of testing institutions could change with time; it did not seem necessary to maintain lists of those test laboratories in addition to the lists of issuing authorities. Commenting on Mr Petersen's remarks, he said that issuing authorities could change provided that the rule was observed that there could be only one issuing authority for a given category of instrument in one country.

Mr CHAPPELL said that, about a year earlier, a "newsletter" had been sent out in the USA announcing the System; reports had also been given to the National Conference on Standards Laboratories; many questions had been asked about the OIML System and its links with ISO, IEC etc. The National Conference on Weights and Measures had also been kept informed. (The Conference had a national pattern-approval system very close to that of the OIML Certificate System.) That information had been followed by more detailed studies of the OIML System, comparing it to the national system, and it was to be hoped that there would soon be news about the USA's participation in the OIML System, in which the manufacturers of measuring instruments in the USA appeared to take a keen interest.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked on the interest being shown in several countries in the System. He wondered whether there were yet any more concrete indications. Had there already been any applications for certificates? The metrological services of many countries often received pattern-approval applications; could those services not mention to the applicants that they could obtain an OIML certificate at the same time, provided of course that the instruments concerned were among the categories covered by the System and satisfied OIML requirements?

Mr BENNETT said that he had received requests for information, particularly, as it happened, to indicate whether an OIML Certificate could be granted at the same time as pattern approval. NWML would soon be in a position to perform all the tests prescribed in R 76 and would thus be able to grant such requests if they became firm. Mr BENNETT also wished that the Committee think again about the need to have only one issuing authority for a given category of instruments in one country, as was now demanded. Some departments of the United Kingdom government did not agree with that provision, which bestowed a monopoly on that authority in contravention of the generally accepted principle of open competition.

Mr KOCHSIEK said that there had been much publicity about the System in Germany, and that PTB had already received applications for certificates for nonautomatic weighing instruments. The decision had been made not to issue such certificates before the approval of the new version of R 76; the issue of the first certificates could thus be expected towards the end of 1991.

Mr PETERSEN indicated that several applications had already been made, but he recalled that some time earlier a certificate had been issued for a load cell, though that preliminary certificate was not in the framework of the present System: it had been issued by a test laboratory with the authority of the National Agency; thus the list of issuing authorities should be drawn up to include that laboratory.

Mr OHLON said that "prospective customers" had been told that OIML certificates could be issued; however, so far there did not seem to have been any reactions; perhaps there was some hesitation because of the development currently taking place in Europe of arrangements for the mutual recognition of tests and certificates. The countries of EFTA and the EC had concluded agreements on measuring instruments. What was more, the requirement that there should be a single issuing authority in a country for a category of instrument was not in accord with existing agreements at the European level, because it created a monopoly, as had already been pointed out. Moreover the arrangements agreed in Europe could make it difficult to accept OIML certificates issued by authorities that did not satisfy the rules agreed in those arrangements. The possibility should be considered of bringing the OIML System into the one that the EOTC was setting up in Europe; that would be a help in its development, provided that the requirement of a single issuing authority was abandoned.

Mr BIRKELAND considered that it was difficult to talk about the System's current situation without bringing in its future, and so he invited his colleagues to combine items 5.1 and 5.3 of the agenda if they so wished. That said, he recognized that what Mr Ohlon had said was of interest to the System's future, and his suggestions should be pondered upon, but keeping always in mind the world-wide, international character of OIML's activities: it could not bend to the requirements of one region, but it could take inspiration from the experiences of the various regions to make OIML's system more genuinely useful without loss of its universal character.

Mr STOICHITOIU thought that it was absolutely necessary to make use of the existing "cement", resulting from the work of ISO and IEC, particularly the ISO Standard 9000 on quality assurance that had been adopted as European Standard 45 000; in that sense it was necessary to have a single issuing authority per category of instrument per country.

Mr BAI JINGZHONG said that Chinese enterprises concerned had been informed and that several of them had shown interest in the help that it might give to exports. Laboratories accredited by the National Metrology Service had been selected to perform the tests needed for the issuing of a certificate.

5.2 Recommendations to which the System is applicable

Mr BIRKELAND pointed out that this item covered in fact two items: Recommendations in course of development or of revision to make them suitable for use within the System, and the priorities that OIML would have to adopt so that the Recommendations to which the application of the system was urgently needed were developed or revised quickly.

Mr ATHANÉ indicated that there were currently no new Recommendations to which the System could be applied; indeed the work needed to make some Recommendations suitable for use in the System (in particular drafting model test reports) was proving more time-consuming than had been envisaged; it was expected that those drafts would be ready in good time for the next meeting of the Committee; it was particularly necessary that R 60 on load cells be completed quickly so that the System could apply to it, for many manufacturers were showing a lively interest.

Mr PETERSEN suggested that the priorities adopted by the European Community be taken into account in drawing up a list of work priorities in relation to the OIML Certificates System. In fact the EC, which developed the metrological Directives, and the European bodies responsible for the accompanying standards, waited for the OIML Recommendations in the fields of interest to Europe so that those standards should conform, if possible word for word, to the OIML Recommendations. Mr PETERSEN then drew attention to a recent development in the Commission: the drafting of a single Directive applicable to all measuring instruments subject to legal control, to be supplemented by a European standard for each category of instrument; those standards would be based on OIML requirements, provided that OIML had been able to work fast enough. The standards would be produced according to a list of priorities and it was absolutely necessary that OIML be aware of that list and took it into account in its own work. It was to be expected, however, that the European priorities would coincide, more or less, with those of OIML.

Mr CHAPPELL confirmed that the USA had put in hand the actions necessary for the Recommendations for which they were responsible to be adapted to the System. One was that on load cells, for which a model test report would be circulated shortly; another subject was mass flow meters, as was that of instruments used for the measurement of pollutants. Germany was directly responsible for the Recommendations on air pollution, and countries like Switzerland also had a role to play, but the USA would certainly collaborate effectively in the work as well as in all the secretariats in whose work they participated; in particular, electrical and electronic medical thermometers would have to be given priority.

Mr TUINDER said that the Netherlands considered that the Recommendations on gas meters, for which his country shared responsibility with Germany, and on height gauges for detecting the levels of liquids in tanks, were very important. The Netherlands had already started the work necessary for their inclusion in the System. However, those revisions of existing Recommendations for the stated purpose had also occasioned demands for more fundamental revisions of the texts, and that could entail longer delays than would be the case if it were a matter of simply developing test methods and a model test report.

Mr BIRKELAND saw in Mr Tuinder's remarks a confirmation of the fact that the OIML Certificate System was an opportunity to revitalize the work of OIML and improve the technical content of Recommendations.

Mr BIRCH referred back to some earlier statements and wondered whether some speakers had meant that OIML Recommendations should conform to some of the requirements of the European Community.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that what Mr Petersen had said was that OIML should maintain its leadership and publish in good time Recommendations that represented the best possible consensus and that could be used by regional institutions such as the European Community.

Mr PETERSEN explained that OIML Recommendations were not to be compared to standards but rather to Directives that stated requirements; however recent Directives had undergone a change of form and referred to nonmandatory standards that provided ways of satisfying the Directives. So the OIML Recommendations should be "translated" into standards emanating from CEN or CENELEC, with no loss of their metrological content.

Mr OHLON thought that two questions were being confused: if the OIML Recommendations were to be usable in the System they would have to describe the test methods unambiguously. For the System to be acceptable in Europe it would have to satisfy the requirements for certification developed in Europe, and to that extent it would be very advantageous if it fitted into the framework being developed by EOTC.

Mr BIRKELAND noticed that once again the discussion had returned to item 5.3. He thought that it would be appropriate to take a little more time to acquire some experience of the actual operation of the System in order to be able to start the revision of the System's basic rules in, say, a year's time.

Mr BASTEN thought that the System's future depended greatly on the types of requirements that were harmonized by it; OIML's aims should therefore be made very clear: essential metrological characteristics only, or technical requirements as well? He thought that OIML should limit itself to the essential metrological requirements and leave the technical aspects to the standards institutions; thus OIML's leadership in a perfectly defined domain would not be contested. He suggested moreover that OIML envisage the development a general Recommendation laying down the essential requirements of all instruments within its domain.

Mr BIRCH noticed that the discussion, having started from a consideration of a fairly rigid system with one issuing authority, a clutch of Recommendations and a method of proving conformity to those Recommendations, was now about a system that was more vague; the essential point of it all was to establish mutual confidence between issuing authorities; did that require that the procedures to be followed be very tightly specified or would it be sufficient to lay down the essential requirements? That should be made clear to the OIML working groups to avoid unnecessary work.

Mr BENNETT recognized that the question of mutual confidence in the work of certification was essential, and he indicated that WELMEC would be discussing it at their next meeting. Within OIML there could be circulations of instruments, to be tested by several issuing authorities, and the setting up of audit groups to monitor what happened in the various countries, but that could transform OIML into an accreditation body. The encouragement of reciprocal-recognition agreements between national accreditation systems was another possibility. The requirements would have to be written in as much detail as possible to avoid differing interpretations. However, none of those possible courses of action would alone be sufficient and it would no doubt be necessary to adopt more than one simultaneously. Mutual confidence would also spring from a study of the first certificates issued and of the accompanying test reports.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that the preceding debate had completely disposed of item 5.2, even if it had also encroached on the following item. It was essential to the System that there be a group of Recommendations containing detailed specifications, as much for the instruments as for the test methods. That was not yet the case, but there was a promising number of Recommendations being developed or revised that could later be suitable for use in the System. The Member States should not try to do too much at once, for resources were limited and it would be better to concentrate on matters that were really of high priority.

5.3 The evolution of the System in the years to come

Mr BIRKELAND, continuing the drift of his previous remarks, said that many ideas about the future of the System had already been expressed and, as no one sought the floor, concluded the discussion with the proposal that the Committee acquire another year's experience before proceeding, if necessary, to a revision of the System's basic rules. Naturally all the ideas that had been expressed orally would be kept by the Bureau as working material for the Committee at its next meeting.

6 PROCEDURES AND STRUCTURES FOR THE TECHNICAL WORK OF OIML

6.1 Procedures for the technical work of OIML

Mr BIRKELAND introduced the third draft of the *Procedures for the technical work of OIML* (part one of the Directives being developed) and made clear his intention to allow a wide discussion of the subject because of its extreme importance for OIML. The existing working methods were nearly twenty years old, and even though they had given a decisive thrust to the work, they had shown some deficiencies. Rather than revise them it had appeared to be preferable to develop new work procedures, taking into account the developments in common in ISO and IEC. Two successive drafts had been developed by the Bureau and discussed by the Presidential Council, which had finally asked the Bureau to prepare a third draft for discussion at Committee level. As indicated in the accompanying explanatory paper, the third draft could, depending on the Committee's reaction, either be adopted immediately subject to editorial revision, or be revised more fundamentally for resubmission to the Committee for adoption, or be rejected by the Committee, in which case it would be necessary to start again practically from scratch.

Mr CHAPPELL said that he had a very large number of detailed comments about the draft but he would restrict himself to his most important criticisms. He agreed that it was necessary to revise OIML's working methods and make them more effective. The preliminary proposal submitted by the Bureau at Oporto was not broad enough or sufficiently general. Moreover he had been unable to take part in the Council's discussion in February 1991 and that explained why he now had many comments to make. The third draft was too complex, difficult to interpret and inadequate to surmount the difficulties that had been identified. It marked too great a break with the current methods, and it was in conflict with the *Guide for CIML Members*; it lacked a clear appeals procedure, which was not currently the case; the text was said to be based on the directives of ISO and IEC, although it departed from them significantly; and moreover, was it really necessary to adopt the IEC and ISO directives, which were appropriate to the scale of those institutions but perhaps not to that of OIML? In conclusion, Mr Chappell was not in favour of the draft.

Mr OHLON asked for an explanation of the respective roles of the secretariat and of the chairman of a technical committee (CT) or of a sub-committee (SC), for the Bureau's view did not seem to accord with the practices of ISO and IEC, for whom the secretariat and the chairman had to come from the same country; in the same way the manner of the appointment of a working group and of its convenor should be more precisely described; and the text was very complex, as the USA's delegate had already remarked.

Mr ATHANÉ offered some explanations and reminded Members that the directives of ISO and IEC envisaged, and even encouraged, the possibility of a secretariat and a chairman from different countries. In any case, even if they were from the same country, the chairman and the secretariat had different roles which complemented and balanced each other. As for the working groups, Mr ATHANÉ reminded the Committee that their object was mainly to ensure that the "first committee drafts" already had a certain international character and were of an acceptable editorial quality; naturally if the principle of working groups was accepted the details of how they were to work would have to be made clear.

Mr OHLON said that in ISO and IEC the essential work was done at the level of the working group and that all interested committee members took part in it; that eliminated the risk of a preponderance of influence of the secretariat or chairman.

Mr PETERSEN was worried about the complexity of the document and by a kind of "upward movement" of responsibility; in particular the CIML could find itself loaded with responsibilities that it could not discharge, meeting annually; it would either be necessary to establish an intermediate body or increase the number of meetings of CIML.

Mr BIRKELAND recognized the soundness of that remark but said that the Presidential Council could assume some responsibilities in CIML's name and enlist the help of the advisory groups or ad hoc groups for which the procedures made provision.

Mr KNAPP had difficulty with the notion of a member of a working group acting only as an expert and not as his country's representative.

Mr BRINKMANN indicated his general support for the draft; ISO and IEC had great experience in the production of standards and OIML could benefit from that experience. However, the minimum number of P-members adopted by ISO and IEC was far too small if one considered the specific nature of OIML and, to diminish the risk of having a draft rejected by CIML, the minimum number of P-members participating in its development would have to be increased considerably. It would also be necessary to think again about the nature of the task given to working groups and not limit it to the preparation of first committee drafts, but associate them also with the work that followed. Moreover, extra delays should not be introduced at the time of approval by the fact that countries that were interested, but had not taken part in the development of the draft, presented numerous comments at the final stage. Finally a numbering system for working documents like that of ISO and IEC should be introduced.

Mr KNAPP agreed with Mr Brinkmann's remarks, in particular to increase the minimum number of P-members; a project should be undertaken only if there was real international interest, and five P-members were far too few in that regard; there should be at least ten.

Mr CHAPPELL remarked that, for most Member States, the CIML Members did not have experts in their national services that were capable of taking part in all the work of OIML; the responsibility of Members of CIML was to identify national interests and

to find national bodies capable of taking part in OIML's work; but in some cases (health and safety, for example) it could be very difficult to find experts willing to take part in OIML work, and that should be taken into account in deciding what should be the minimum size of the CTs and SCs.

Mr BIRCH thought that a careful reading and rereading of the text showed that many of the objectives, in particular about the open character of the work and the prevention of a take-over by this or that interest, had been achieved. The rules established to that end were in the main good to the extent that they applied to the CTs and SCs. As far as the working groups were concerned there could be problems of duality arising from the participation of persons who would have to act as experts and not as national representatives. The working group would have to work with speed and efficiency without being subject to overstrict rules, and the role of the convenor was paramount. The fact that the working group was supposed to take part only at the initial stage, then pass responsibility for the remainder of the work to the CT or SC, would no doubt correct some of the deficiencies at the start; but the working group's experts could become discouraged if they considered their role to be of very limited duration: it was very desirable that the experts could participate in the remainder of the work, then being under the stricter rules applicable to CTs and SCs. It was also necessary to reduce the other risk, that of the CTs' and SCs' finding their roles reduced to that of accepting without discussion texts prepared by the working groups. With that in mind the process by which P-members nominated experts who would constitute the working groups should be re-examined: the current formulation seemed to contain internal inconsistencies. Finally Mr BIRCH expressed disquiet about the possibility that the working groups might not be genuinely international in character, but rather regional, because of the difficulties that geographically distant countries had in participating. The use of modern means of communication, allowing participation at long distance, should be recommended to reduce the risk of regionalization.

Mr KNAPP asked whether it was possible for the secretariat and the chairman of a CT or SC, and the convenor of a working group, all to be from different countries. How then would the work, meetings etc. be coordinated?

Mr ATHANÉ said that such a possibility could be envisaged, provided that the countries in question were all P-members of the CT or SC; it was for the CT or SC to decide, according to the circumstances. It was to be noted that the proposed procedures offered great flexibility to future technical committees, who could make good use of it to improve their efficiency.

Mr CHAPPELL expressed his concern about the parts relating to the way in which the working groups would function: there was mention of the use of international standards, but not of national regulations or standards, which were supposed to be harmonized by OIML Recommendations. The rules for the appointment of chairmen also needed clarification, for the text was unclear on this point. Also, since the independence of the chairman with regard to the secretariat seemed to be important, mention should be made of the resources at the chairman's disposal, for only the resources at the disposal of the secretariat were mentioned.

Mr ATHANÉ replied that quite obviously national regulations had to be taken into consideration by working groups, and for that matter the existence of working groups would ensure that the work started from a broader base and would be thus more international than was currently the case; whereas if there was already an international standard on the subject with which a CT or SC was dealing, OIML was practically bound to base its work on that standard (either by reference or by partial recopying); that was why that case had been mentioned. The ways in which chairmen were appointed could be revised. Finally, as regarded the resources available to a chairman, it was up to the country accepting responsibility for the chairmanship to provide whatever resources were necessary.

Mr REFEROWSKI was, on the whole, satisfied with the Bureau's draft; some of its principles were to be retained: no change in the duties and responsibilities of the Conference and of the Committee; take account of the fact that P-members were in fact States; the work to start in a working group of an ad hoc nature and composed of experts rather than countries. But Mr REFEROWSKI did not see the need for both technical committees and sub-committees. Many of the comments made by members present were excellent (particularly about the size of CTs and SCs: how could a clear decision be reached by five members if two were for and three against a proposal?). He suggested that a group be established to discuss the draft and help the Bureau to put the finishing touches to it; he offered to serve on such a group.

Mr VIRIEUX was of the opinion that the aim of giving the greatest possible flexibility to the various organs of OIML had been attained. The diagrams at the end of the text clarified it very well; it constituted an excellent working base.

Mr OHLON accepted the principles of what had been said, but there was one point that troubled him: standards work was on national delegations that represented all interests. It should be the same in OIML; it was clearly the responsibility of the CIML Member to see that all national interests took part in the work of OIML.

Mr BIRKELAND reminded Mr Ohlon that he (Mr Birkeland) had just drawn attention to that responsibility in his opening remarks, and Mr ATHANÉ said that it was clearly mentioned in the *Guide for CIML Members*; the next version of the *Guide* could emphasize the point still further. However, the *Procedures* were not a statement of working policy: they were a description of the procedures to be followed in the development of Recommendations, and that was not the place to mention the participation of all interested parties in the work of OIML under the coordination of CIML Members.

Mr CHAPPELL remarked that the draft gave OIML Members responsibilities that were, in his view, in conflict with the *Guide*; so the revision of the *Guide* should proceed in parallel with the development of the *Procedures*.

Mr BENNETT thought that the draft constituted a good base that could be improved. However, he did not see how a better coordination or management of the work, eliminating the former deficiencies, would be achieved, and he thought that CIML would be overwhelmed by new tasks.

Mr PETERSEN was in complete agreement with what had just been said. He thought that CIML would be assuming an enormous task; how could it do it effectively?

Mr VOORHOF was generally in favour of the Bureau's proposals. It was desirable that the mechanisms by which Recommendations were developed became similar to those used for the development of standards; it would facilitate the use of OIML Recommendations by standards organizations, in particular the European organization. He wondered, however, whether the production of Recommendations would be any quicker under the new procedures.

Mr ATHANÉ began by replying to Mr Voorhof: the new procedures ought not to increase delays and could indeed shorten them. No doubt the working group would need longer to develop the first committee draft than was currently required by a reporting secretariat to produce a first preliminary draft, but after that the work should be able to proceed more rapidly since a certain measure of agreement would already have been achieved in the working group, and the delays of two-tier approval (reporting then pilot) that were currently experienced would no longer exist. Moreover the new procedures in the working group would ensure that texts would emerge that were well written in French and English, which would greatly reduce the later editorial work

of the Bureau. Accelerated procedures would be worked out shortly. Turning to Mr Bennett, Mr ATHANÉ pointed out that under the new procedures the CIML would exercise a dual control over the work: in approving work projects and in allocating them to either existing technical committees or new ones specially formed, thus avoiding the risk of working bodies taking on work that was of no priority for most Member States. On the other hand the technical committees would have the responsibility of proposing the creation of subcommittees to develop projects that CIML had allocated to them. The coordination of a reduced number of subcommittees established at the request of the technical committee would be easier for the latter than that which the pilot secretariats were currently supposed to exercise with regard to reporting secretariats, many of which had long existed in their own right.

Mr PETERSEN asked who would exercise practical control over the technical committees.

Mr ATHANÉ replied that that was CIML's responsibility, as it was currently for the general control of the pilot secretariats and reporting secretariats; but the CIML should continue to enlist the help of the Presidential Council and, if necessary, "advisory groups" could be created, either by CIML or the Presidential Council, to consider in detail the course of the work and other matters to do with the CTs and SCs.

Mr PETERSEN expressed the hope that that form of management would be more effective than that currently existing.

Mr OHLON suggested that OIML take advantage of the experience of the standards organizations, whose technical committees meet regularly, normally once a year, to discuss the work that had been done and plan the work for the following year.

Mr KNAPP said that, to improve efficiency and reduce delays in producing Recommendations, it would be better to improve the existing *Working Method* as necessary, rather than go back to the beginning.

Mr ATHANÉ replied that that had been the Bureau's original intention when it had proposed the revision of the *Working Method* in 1988. However, at the Eighth Conference it had seemed preferable to start from scratch, because certain delegations had strongly urged the Bureau to look to the new directives of ISO and IEC, because it seemed that something completely new would make it easier to get rid of former bad practices, and finally because it seemed to be essential that the complete general programme of work of OIML be reviewed and that work that was of no general interest be abandoned. That would be easier if a fresh start was made. He pointed out that, if OIML was not a standards organization in the sense that ISO and IEC were, Recommendations could still be produced according to procedures that were close to those used for international standards. Mr ATHANÉ added that the differences applied only to the working procedures of the technical committees and subcommittees in relation to the current pilot secretariats and reporting secretariats; those of the Conference, the Committee and the Presidential Council were little affected.

Mr EMERSON, having noted that a number of CIML Members seemed to be worried about the increase in CIML's responsibilities, remarked that, in relation to the existing situation, only two new tasks would be added: the appointment of chairmen of technical committees and the approval of new work projects. The CIML had always been responsible for the approval of the work programmes of the pilot secretariats and reporting secretariats; there would be no great change *vis a vis* the current position; the Bureau had made a point of giving to CIML only those tasks that were necessarily its responsibility, with the provision that CIML could appoint advisory groups to help it in its work.

Mr VIRIEUX thought that the most important consideration was that the production of OIML Recommendations should be speeded up. It would be a disaster if a country, or still worse a group of countries, decided to enact necessary regulations without reference to OIML because OIML was incapable of producing the corresponding Recommendation in time; it would be very difficult for such a country or group of countries to adapt its national or regional regulations later to OIML's requirements. Mr VIRIEUX was convinced that the proposed new procedures would allow that quickening of the pace to occur, though obviously the procedures could be perfected later in the light of experience.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that Members of CIML on the whole favoured the draft, which would, however, have to be carefully revised and improved. For that purpose the comments made at the meeting would have to be compiled by the Bureau with, of course, all additional comments that CIML Members might send to the Bureau in the very near future. To take up Mr Referowski's proposal, that gentleman, Mr Brinkmann and Mr Chappell would form a drafting group with the task of helping the Bureau to prepare a new text to be discussed by the Presidential Council at the beginning of 1992, before instructing the Bureau to prepare a final draft that the Committee might approve either by correspondence or, at the latest, at its next meeting.

6.2 Drafting and presentation of OIML International Recommendations

Mr BIRKELAND indicated that the matter was independent of the *Procedures* and that it had been the subject, at CIML's request, of preparatory work by the Bureau, discussions within the Presidential Council, followed by consultation of the Members of CIML, before arriving at the final draft submitted to CIML for its approval. If CIML's decision was favourable, the *Guide* could be brought into use straight away.

Mr CHAPPELL indicated his agreement in principle with the draft; he had, however, a number of comments that he would send to the Bureau to help it in perfecting the final text.

Mr BRINKMANN was also in agreement, but had two comments: in the constituent elements of a Recommendation, "normative references", that was to say references to other standards that formed part of the standard in question (as opposed to references purely for information) should be added; and also OIML should do as ISO and IEC do in advocating the use of the comma as the decimal sign.

Mr ATHANÉ said that the Bureau would consider the matter of normative references, but he feared that that might raise difficulties in OIML. As for the decimal sign, it was at the request of some Member States that the decimal point had been retained, as well as the comma.

During the general discussion that followed, various, sometimes contradictory opinions were expressed, both about normative references and the decimal sign. In particular, if an OIML Recommendation was developed by reference to an ISO standard or IEC standard, that fact should be stated explicitly in the paragraph headed "Scope" of the Recommendation. The remark was also made that the problem of the decimal point was not the concern only of the English-speaking countries: many countries preferred to use the English versions of the Recommendations and could be inconvenienced if a point was used instead of a comma as the decimal sign.

Mr STOICHITOIU asked whether a list of the operations necessary for initial and subsequent verification, and a list of the verification equipment to be used, could be included among the elements of Recommendations.

Mr BASTEN welcomed the draft and thought that it was very useful.

Mr KURUC was also in favour of the draft; as for normative references, he suggested that they be placed in the informative annexes.

Mr CHAPPELL said that among the comments that he would send to the Bureau was a proposal that the test methods be placed in a mandatory annex, which would allow them to be revised in the light of experience without having to revise the main body of the Recommendation.

Mr OHLON asked that care be taken to make only references by exact identification to ISO and IEC standards; he considered that some of the examples in 6.4.4 were incorrect in that regard.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded by asking that all the remarks made during the meeting, as well as those that CIML Members might send to the Bureau, be used by the latter to prepare the final draft of the *Guide to the drafting and presentation of OIML Recommendations*, which Mr Birkeland considered as approved unanimously by the Committee.

6.3 New structures to be established in application of the procedures

Mr BIRKELAND introduced the Bureau's preliminary proposal for the new structures to be established in application of the future procedures, since it appeared that CIML was in agreement in principle with the procedures discussed under item 6.1. The Bureau's proposal consisted of a list of projects that could lead to the drafting of new Recommendations or to the revision of existing Recommendations.

Mr VÉGLIA remarked that SP 17 had developed a number of Recommendations on instruments for use in the measurement of pollutants; those instruments were checked largely by the use of certified reference materials. It was therefore necessary that those certified reference materials be given at least midterm priority.

Mr CHAPPELL agreed with the preceding remark and thought that a guide on the use of certified reference materials would be useful. He agreed in principle with the proposal for the new structures, but he had some comments on some particular projects or on their places in the structure. In particular he considered that some projects (material testing machines, pressure) that were included in field number 5 (mass and associated quantities) were not in the right place, which made the field too broad and incoherent for a single technical committee. He would inform the Bureau of his views on some of the reporting secretariats for which the USA was responsible and whose activities did not feature among the projects.

Mr BASTEN regretted that some of the fields that could fall to the responsibility of a technical committee comprised a very small number of projects; there was an imbalance with respect to other fields and some regrouping would have to be envisaged.

Mr OHLON agreed with what had been said. He was also worried about field number 7, where there was a risk of OIML's work on electricity meters overlapping that of IEC. Mr BASTEN did not agree with that view: on the contrary, he thought that the subject was of great importance to legal metrology.

Mr GAVRAILOV and Mr SIMEONOV both thought that the new structures would contribute to an improvement in the work of OIML. However, they had some remarks on measurements of ionizing radiations in medical dosimetry and protection, and thought that that very interesting subject ought to have been placed in field number 10. Saccharimetry, on the other hand, should not have been classified under physicochemical measurements, but rather under optical measurements. Finally, reference materials had to remain among the projects of high priority.

Mr REFEROWSKI accepted the idea that the projects be divided according to physical quantities, but with the addition of some general fields, and some horizontal ones. Bulgaria's proposals about measuring instruments for ionizing radiations should be considered, given that those instruments could be used in medicine or in the monitoring of the environment. But those were points of detail, and the main thing was to agree on the general principles of the division of the projects.

Mr OHLON remarked that some of the secretariats in charge of projects mentioned in the Bureau's proposal had not been very active up to then; what could be done to bring about some real action?

Mr BIRKELAND wound up the discussion and asked CIML Members to put their comments in writing to the Bureau before 1991.12.30 so that a new proposal could be discussed by the Presidential Council at the beginning of 1992, then that the final proposal might be sent to CIML Members for discussion by correspondence. It had to be remembered that the new structures would have to be in place by 1993.01.01. To calm Mr Ohlon's fears, the projects that would finally be retained were those in which some real activity could develop. Mr Birch made the remark that the final proposal would have to mention the subcommittees to be established if the new structures were really to be in place by 1993.01.01. Mr BIRKELAND agreed, and he asked his colleagues not to overlook that point in the comments that they would send the Bureau before the end of 1991.

7 WORK OF THE SECRETARIATS

7.1 State of progress of work

Mr BIRKELAND indicated that the paper entitled *State of progress of the work of OIML Secretariats*, dated 1991.08.31 and brought up to date to 1991.09.30, had been distributed for the information of those present.

Mr ATHANÉ added that in February 1991 the Presidential Council had received a report on the activities of the secretariats up to the end of 1990, with in particular the statistics on the comparison between the actual progress of the work and the plans approved in 1988 for the period 1989 to 1992. It appeared that out of 135 secretariats, 73 were inactive, (43 because their work was finished, and 30 because the work that had been envisaged had been suspended for various reasons); of the 62 active secretariats, 21 were within six months or so of their targets, 2 were ahead, 23 were 12 to 18 months behind and 16 were more than 18 months behind. Mr ATHANÉ reminded Members that news about the secretariats was given every year in the March issue of the OIML Bulletin.

7.2 Particular secretariats

7.2.a Vacant secretariats

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee that the Bureau had conducted an enquiry to find candidates to take responsibility for the secretariats that had become vacant following requests by the countries formerly responsible to divest themselves of those responsibilities.

Following the enquiry the following secretariats were allocated as indicated:

- SP 2-Sr 5 "Control by sampling" to Rumania, after Germany had withdrawn its candidacy,
- SP 10-Sr 1 "Measurement of the speed of vehicles" to the United Kingdom, after Rumania had withdrawn its candidacy,

- SP 16-Sr 1 "Dosimeters" to either the United Kingdom or the USSR, to be decided by agreement between the two countries, after Germany had withdrawn,
- SP 4 "Measurement of length, area and angle" to the United Kingdom.

The following Secretariats remained without countries responsible, owing to an absence of candidates: SP 19 "Measurement of characteristics of materials" and SP 19-SR 3 "Hardness (reference blocks and testing machines)".

7.2.b The situation of one secretariat

Mr BIRKELAND reminded Members that the secretariat SP 30-Sr 1 should have revised Recommendation R 54 on the pH scales of aqueous solutions to align it with the IUPAC Recommendation. However, the Recommendation not having yet been so revised despite repeated reminders from the Bureau, the latter had been obliged to suspend the work of SP 30-Sr 1. It was noted that it had not yet been possible to hold the projected meeting between experts of IUPAC and of OIML, and that the experts were not unanimously in favour of IUPAC's decisions. The Committee decided to postpone discussion of this matter, in particular whether to confirm or cancel R 54, until its next meeting.

7.3 Adoption of International Recommendations

By the vote of which the results are given in Annex 1, the Committee approved the following International Recommendations for immediate publication and submission to the Ninth Conference for formal sanction:

- Sound calibrators,
- Measuring instrumentation for human response to vibration,
- Pure-tone audiometers,
- Nonautomatic weighing instruments (R 76 revised).

The approval of R 76 included an amendment on electrostatic discharges notified by Mr KOCHSIEK and, as pointed out by Mr ATHANÉ, applied to both parts of the Recommendation since that proposal had been circulated by the Bureau by post and had not been opposed by any CIML Member. Mr BRINKMANN indicated that he would bring some editorial corrections to the attention of the Bureau before the Recommendations concerned were printed.

8 LIAISON WITH SOME INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

At Mr BIRKELAND's request, Mr ATHANÉ submitted brief reports on the relations between OIML and some international and regional institutions.

The bodies of the Metre Convention: those relations were very good and raised no difficulties of overlap or of conflict in their work.

ISO and IEC: relations were also very good even if, in some technical activities, there could be points of conflict due to the fact that standardization and legal metrology could view the same subject differently. At that very moment a World Summit on Standardization, and the General Assembly of ISO, were being held in Madrid, and OIML was represented at both of them. Mr EMERSON supplemented those remarks with a brief progress report on the work on the vocabulary and on uncertainties being done under the aegis of ISO/TAG4 (in which BIPM, IEC, OIML and other institutions

took part). BIML took an active part in the work: it had taken responsibility for certain studies and had organized meetings; the CIML also participated in the person of Mr Chappell; work on the vocabulary (revision of the VIM) was nearing completion; that on uncertainties was happily nearing its conclusion, and the matter of coherence with ISO/TC69 was being addressed. Mr CHAPPELL insisted on the need to complete the work on vocabulary very quickly because of its importance to OIML. In reply to a question from Mr BIRCH it was indicated that the new edition of the VIM would probably be available towards the end of 1992. Mr BRINKMANN was told that the work of ISO/TAG 4 in no way conflicted with the earlier work of WECC.

European metrological and standardization bodies: Mr ATHANÉ described briefly the aims of EUROMET, WECC, WELMEC and COOMET (recently set up by the countries of eastern and central Europe) and their cooperation with OIML. As regarded activities of a regulatory nature, Mr ATHANÉ described the development of cooperation that formerly had been centred exclusively on the Commission of the European Communities (responsible for proposing Directives which, in the field of metrology, were practically identical to the Recommendations of OIML) and which was currently moving in the direction of the two European standards organizations, CEN and CENELEC. Those last could either receive mandates from the Commission to produce standards to complement the metrological Directives (or the single general Directive currently being drafted); they could also decide on their own initiative to draft standards on measuring instruments. CEN and OIML had very quickly reached agreement on cooperation; an identical draft agreement had not initially found favour with CENELEC, but the latter had recently changed its mind (following a change of Secretary General) and an agreement could shortly be concluded. The main aim of those agreements was, for OIML, to ensure that European standards in the metrological field were compatible with the corresponding OIML Recommendations, whether those standards were produced with a mandate from the Commission or on the independent initiative of CEN or CENELEC. There was already an example of cooperation with regard to nonautomatic weighing instruments: the Bureau had accepted a heavy additional work load to draft a standard based on R 76, but now the work had been taken over by DIN (the German standards committee) and the cooperation had proved to be very fruitful. Mr ATHANÉ added that what he had just said about the Commission applied equally to EFTA, as CEN and CENELEC embraced the countries of the European Community and EFTA. Mr ATHANÉ concluded his remarks by stressing the nonexclusive character of the cooperation between OIML and the regional institutions: what was being done at that time with western European organizations could be done in the future in any other region of the world.

Mr BENNETT confirmed and added to Mr Athané's remarks about WELMEC, which would shortly be meeting in Vienna. Harmonization and communication were currently the principal aims of WELMEC, for example the harmonization of pattern-approval certificates and other matters linked to certification.

Mr REFEROWSKI gave some information about the recent establishment of COOMET, the purpose of which was take up some aspects of the cooperation that had existed through CAEM, but with a less formal structure. Other countries could take part as associate members: such was the case with Germany, besides the full members who were currently Bulgaria, Poland, Rumania, Czechoslovakia and USSR; an association with EUROMET, WECC and WELMEC was one of COOMET's aims.

Mr OHLON indicated that some projects of CEN and CENELEC could create difficulties of compatibility with the corresponding work of OIML, unless OIML showed itself capable of bringing that work to a rapid conclusion: there were also cases (heat meters, for example) where the OIML work was difficult to apply in some European countries.

9 DEVELOPING COUNTRIES

Mr THULIN indicated that in 1991 this activity had been limited to the organization, in close cooperation with Germany (PTB and DAM), of a training course on the verification of certain weighing instruments. (It had not proved possible to organize a similar course that had been envisaged for France). The course had been of particular interest to the developing countries, though trainees from other countries had also been invited under the aegis of cooperative agreements with Germany. The total number of course members was twenty. OIML, for its part, had covered the travel costs (from the Development Council's budget, as agreed in 1990) of four trainees from developing countries that were members of OIML. The success of the course had been such that the German authorities had decided to repeat it in June and July 1992, and CIML was asked whether it would allow the Bureau to participate in this second presentation and cover the travelling expenses of two trainees. Mr THULIN added that it would no doubt be necessary later, perhaps in 1993, to call a meeting of the OIML Development Council to reconsider OIML policy in that field. Mr THULIN also gave some information about the booklets produced by the Bureau, mainly for the developing countries.

Mr REVUELTA FORMOSO reported on the training courses organized annually in Cuba and to which the developing countries of Central and South America were invited. Cuba would also be organizing a seminar and exhibition on metrology in 1993, and OIML was invited to consider the possibility of participating in them in one form or another. He added that Cuba had undertaken the translation of the OIML Recommendations into Spanish.

The GERMAN DELEGATION informed the Committee about other courses that its country was organizing independently for developing countries, in particular in the field of medical measuring instruments.

Mr NOUMSI, expressing his regret that OIML had not been able to act on his proposal of 1990 to organize courses in the developing countries, suggested that the real training needs of the developing countries needed better definition; he asked that an enquiry be launched to determine what kinds of training projects would be of particular interest to those countries.

Mr STOICHITOIU and others expressed their appreciation of Germany's activities in the field of training courses, and their wish that information on the subject be widely distributed.

Mr BIRCH, for his part, supported Cameroon's proposal.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that CIML had expressed no opposition to the Bureau's proposals and asked the Bureau to restart the enquiry into the needs of the developing countries that had been made some years earlier, and he expressed his thanks to the countries that were becoming active in support of the developing countries.

10 OIML SEMINARS

Mr THULIN reported on the preparations for the organization of a technical seminar on instruments for measurement of air pollution, proposed by Switzerland, which would take place in Interlaken in September 1992. Papers would focus on the verification of instruments (in particular those used for vehicle exhausts, already the subject of an OIML Recommendation), but other subjects could also be addressed and institutions such as ISO (TC 146) would be invited. Details would be given later, in or about November, but Mr THULIN wished to bring this seminar to the attention of those present straight away so that offers of papers could be sent to the Bureau without delay.

11 REPORT ON THE ACTIVITIES OF THE BUREAU (October 1990 to September 1991)

A written report was distributed to those present for information.

12 ELECTION OF A VICE-PRESIDENT OF THE COMMITTEE

On the President's nomination, the Committee elected Mr M. KOCHSIEK, CIML Member for Germany, as its Vice-President, by acclamation.

Mr KOCHSIEK expressed his thanks to his colleagues and assured them of his keen interest in OIML's affairs.

13 PREPARATIONS FOR THE NINTH CONFERENCE

Mr KAPONIKOLOS informed the Committee about the preparations for the Ninth Conference, which he proposed should be held in the first week of November 1992 to take advantage of the very attractive hotel prices obtaining at that time, and in conformity with the results of an enquiry conducted by the Bureau; the venue would be the Astir Palace Hotel in the tourist complex at Vouliagmeni, 25 km south of Athens. Mr Athané had already visited the site of the meeting and the details would be settled later in strict consultation with the Bureau. Mr KAPONIKOLOS expressed his pleasure in giving the delegates of OIML Member States the opportunity to discover Greek hospitality and to appreciate Greece as a whole.

The Committee made no comment on the Bureau's proposals for the agenda for the Conference or on the budget that could be submitted for the Conference's consideration. As regarded the budget, draft estimates would be sent officially to the Member States towards the end of 1991, seeking their comments so that a final proposal could be included in the papers for the Conference, which should be sent out in the spring of 1992.

14 OTHER MATTERS

14.1 OIML Bulletin

Mr THULIN spoke about the Bulletin, for which he was responsible, and his difficulties in obtaining technical articles other than papers given at various technical seminars, which had been the Bulletin's mainstay. He also pointed out that a great effort had been made to increase the amount of information about Member States, meetings on metrology, books and journals on the subject, etc. He regretted that the contributions came always from the same small group of countries.

Mr BIRCH expressed his satisfaction with the contents of the Bulletin, but he suggested that some of the information given to the Committee be published in it, in particular that on relations between OIML and other institutions, and on the ways in which metrology was likely to evolve in Europe.

On the Committee's behalf Mr BIRKELAND expressed his high satisfaction with the technical and informative level of the Bulletin.

14.2 Instituting a world metrology day

Mr STOICHITOIU explained his reasons for the proposal: activities such as standardization and "quality" all had their "world days", and metrology suffered from not having one as well; such a day would enhance relations between manufacturers, test laboratories, control authorities and the public, and make every one more aware of metrology in general and legal metrology in particular; it would also be an occasion to publish articles, organize seminars etc., whether at national level or internationally.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that for the moment the bodies of the Metre Convention did not wish to associate themselves with this initiative.

Mr PETERSEN did not think that it was always necessary to try to link scientific metrology with legal metrology; there were occasions when legal metrology had its own identity, and there could be initiatives that were independent of other branches of metrology. In that sense Mr PETERSEN felt a certain sympathy for Mr Stoichitoiu's proposal.

Mr KNAPP said that a legal-metrology day focused on weights and measures in retailing had been organized some time in Canada; it had required a large committee to plan it, had been expensive, and the results had been rather disappointing; it would be impossible for OIML to take responsibility for such a movement internationally.

Mr BIRCH recognized the practical difficulties, but thought nevertheless that OIML ought, in the medium or long term, to involve itself in nontechnical subjects with links with legal metrology, for the example the impact of its activities on the consumer or on industry. In that sense, a movement such as that proposed by Mr Stoichitoiu could later become a normal consequence of such a development in OIML's activities.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that nearly all who had taken part in the debate thought that instituting a world metrology day immediately would be unrealistic; however, there was no need to renounce all thought of such a day, and OIML should think about it, even if now was not the time for it.

Mr STOICHITOIU said that he had not suggested that OIML itself organize demonstrations, but only that it choose a day and encourage its Member States to promote the day by their activities.

Mr BENNETT proposed that legal metrology bodies at national level use the world days for standardization and quality to publicise the roll of legal metrology in those domains and on its own account.

14.3 Relations between OIML and the industries manufacturing measuring instruments

The Committee noted the content of a letter from CECIP (Comité Européen des Constructeurs d'Instruments de Pesage - European committee of weighing-machine manufacturers), in which the European manufacturers indicated their intention to urge their national authorities to put OIML Recommendations into effect as soon as they were published, and asking OIML to urge its Member States to associate manufacturers with the work of OIML, whether in national working groups or in national delegations at meetings. OIML was also asked to insist that Recommendations be written in terms of the metrological performance to be achieved, and not to include design requirements, because the latter could be a brake on innovation and impede progress.

Mr BIRKELAND emphasized that, although the request came from a regional association, it was no less of general import, especially the last two points, which had already been discussed on several occasions in the Committee and the Conference with the same conclusions as those voiced in CECIP's request.

Mr PETERSEN said that, since those points had long been OIML working policy, it was a matter of putting it effectively into practice and finding practical means to that end.

Mr BIRCH expressed his agreement in principle with the proposal, provided that it was clearly limited to OIML's technical work, and did not apply to other activities such as those pertaining to the Conference. Moreover the participation of industry in the technical work would have to be in accordance with rules that were known and clear to everybody, and which ought, for example, to feature in the procedures for the technical work or in some other appropriate text.

Mr BIRKELAND drew attention to the advantages for OIML of industry's cooperation.

Mr CHAPPELL indicated that it had long been the policy of the USA to associate manufacturers and users of instruments with the US national working groups of OIML; it was acceptable that a manufacturer represent a Member State at an OIML meeting provided that that manufacturer put aside his commercial interests and represented his country's overall interest.

Mr REFEROWSKI drew attention to the obvious ties between manufacturers and the legal metrology services; such cooperation had always been sought in Poland, and a delegation from CECIP would shortly visit his country.

At the conclusion of the debate the COMMITTEE expressed its satisfaction with the intentions of the manufacturers to apply pressure to the national authorities to put OIML Recommendations into effect quickly. It also reiterated the following elements of OIML working policy:

- CIML Members were invited to associate manufacturers of measuring instruments, and all other interested parties, closely with the technical work of OIML, both in national working groups and in delegations to meetings,
- OIML Recommendations should be worded in terms of metrological performances that instruments should be capable of achieving, and methods of test, not in terms of technical solutions or design requirements for instruments, for that could be a restraint on technical progress.

15 DATE AND PLACE OF NEXT MEETING

It was confirmed that the twenty-seventh meeting of the Committee would take place in November 1992 in Athens, on the occasion of the Ninth Conference.

The Committee accepted Germany's invitation to hold its twenty-eighth meeting in Berlin in 1993.

DECISIONS

The reports of decisions submitted to the Committee for its twenty-sixth meeting were read out and amended, and the decisions were confirmed; they are reproduced below.

CLOSE

Before closing the meeting of the Committee Mr BIRKELAND referred to the fourteen years and five years respectively that Mr Thulin and Mr Emerson would have spent at the Bureau when they retired during the year 1992.

Besides taking an active part in the work of certain secretariats, in particular in the field of the measurement of pollution, Mr Thulin had considerably expanded OIML's activity in support of developing countries, using the experience that he had gained in UNESCO and UNIDO. The Committee had just received a report on that subject. He had also written a number of booklets of interest not only to those countries but also to the industrialized countries; in particular he had produced booklets on calibration and on the equipment of metrological laboratories, thanks to the scientific experience that Mr Thulin had acquired in Sweden and at BIPM. The Committee had already had occasion to express its appreciation of the excellent standing of the Bulletin, as much for the technical articles as for the other informative items (bibliographies, meetings and other events of relevance to metrology, etc.) which it contained; finally Mr Thulin was at the origin of a new activity for OIML, of great utility and attracting very great interest: the technical seminars, of which the seventh was in course of preparation.

Mr Emerson had also taken an active part in the work of certain secretariats: automatic weighing instruments and physicochemical measurements in particular. He had also devoted a great deal of time in the final editing, in an English that was as impeccable in the literary sense as in the technical, of texts published by OIML. The part that he had taken in some of the activities of ISO/TAG 4, and the direct responsibility that he had assumed for certain tasks to do with vocabulary and with uncertainties, had allowed OIML to play an important role alongside BIPM, ISO and IEC. He had also undertaken the heavy task of the complete reexamination of OIML's working procedures. Finally it was mentioned that Mr Emerson had installed the Bureau's computers and configured their software.

Mr THULIN and Mr EMERSON addressed a few words to the Committee about their work in the Bureau.

Mr BIRKELAND then thanked all his colleagues, the interpreters and the Bureau for their contributions in making the Committee's meeting a success. Before closing the meeting he reminded all present that he had been elected President of the Committee in 1980 and reelected in 1986. His term would therefore end in 1992, and he announced that he would not seek reelection; he would be retiring some time after the next meeting. It was therefore up to the Committee to appoint its new President, but Mr BIRKELAND thought that he should offer his colleagues some help and he proposed that they let him know their proposals in that regard during the coming weeks.

Remarking that all the items of the agenda had been discussed and the appropriate decisions taken, Mr BIRKELAND declared closed the twenty-sixth meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology.

DECISIONS TAKEN BY THE COMMITTEE

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 1
Approval of the minutes of the Twenty-fifth meeting of the Committee

The Committee approved the minutes of the Twenty-fifth CIML meeting without modification.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 2.1
New accessions - Expected accessions

The Committee took note of the interest shown by certain countries in joining OIML as Member States or Corresponding Members (South Africa, Argentina, Mexico) or to rejoin OIML (Iran).

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 2.2
The situation of some Member States

The Committee took note of information given orally about the situation of a Member State that was in arrears in its contributions to OIML. Because assurance had been given during the meeting that a part of the arrears would be paid quickly, the Committee did not think that measures against it should be taken for the time being.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 3.1
Approval of the Auditor's report for 1990

The Committee approved the Auditor's report for 1990 and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit it to the Ninth Conference.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 3.2
The financial position in 1991 and 1992

The Committee considered the financial situation of the Organisation in 1991 and took note of a forecast of the likely expenditure in 1992, given orally.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 4.1
Replacement of an Assistant Director retiring from the Bureau in September 1992

The Committee elected as Assistant Director, in place of Mr Thulin: Mr P. DEGAVRE, Belgium, from 1st October 1992.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 4.2
Staff of the Bureau: other matters

The Committee took note of some general information about the current and future employment of staff at the Bureau.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 5.1
Implementation of the OIML Certificate System

The Committee received the information provided by the BIML on the production and distribution of literature and information on the OIML Certificate System, including the use of the Bulletin to provide such information periodically.

The Committee also received information provided by certain Members of the Committee on the application of the System at the national level (informing manufacturers concerned, appointment of issuing authorities, etc.).

The Committee was then informed of the forthcoming issue of the first OIML Certificates (with regard to the revised R 76).

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 5.2

Recommendations that may be applied within the System

The Committee received reports from some of its Members on the revision of existing Recommendations relative to their applicability to the System.

The Committee also took note of opinions expressed by some of its Members on the priorities to be observed in the development of Recommendations to which the System should be applicable.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 5.3

The evolution of the System during the coming years

The Committee took note of opinions expressed by some of its Members on the possible ways in which the System might develop.

The Committee expressed its agreement that the System should continue to operate in its present form until the next meeting of the Committee, at which an ad hoc group could be established for the purpose of revising the texts on which the System is based.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 6.1

Procedures for the OIML technical work

The Committee took note of the generally favourable opinion expressed by its Members on the third draft "Procedures for the technical work of OIML". It noted, however, that the numerous comments expressed at the meeting showed the need to review the text before it would be approved.

In consequence the Committee instructed the Bureau to assemble the comments that the Members of CIML might wish to submit in writing, collate them with the comments made orally at the meeting, and send them all to the members of a group comprising Mr Brinkmann (Germany), Mr Chappell (USA) and Mr Referowski (Poland). This group will be required to meet with the Bureau to perfect a new draft, to be submitted to the Presidential Council at its next meeting.

After discussion by the Council, the final draft shall be sent to all the Members of the Committee for approval by correspondence or, at the latest, at the next meeting of the Committee.

The Committee also took note of the need to revise the "Guide for members of CIML", and instructed the Bureau to proceed to this revision under the guidance of the Presidential Council.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 6.2

Drafting and presentation of OIML International Recommendations

The Committee decided that the draft "Guide to the drafting and presentation of OIML International Recommendations" could be considered as approved and could be published after final editing to take account of comments made orally at the meeting and additional comments that some Members of CIML would like to contribute in writing in the near future.

The Committee instructed the Bureau to invite comments and to proceed to final drafting and publication.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 6.3

New structures to be established in application of the procedures

The Committee took note of the generally favourable opinions expressed by its Members on a preliminary proposal for the new work structures to be established for the application of the new procedures.

The Committee asked its Members to send their comments on this proposal to the Bureau before 1991.12.31 so that a report might be submitted to the Presidential Council.

The Committee was aware that the new structures would have to be in place for 1993.1.1 and that consequently the question of the division of the Technical Committees into Subcommittees (not yet dealt with in the Bureau's original proposal) would have to be resolved in sufficient time.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 7.1

State of progress of work

The Committee took note of the document "State of progress of the work of OIML Secretariats" and of information on the comparison between the actual state of progress and the forecasts in the work programme for 1989-1992.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 7.2.a

Particular Secretariats: vacant Secretariats

The Committee allocated the responsibility of vacant Secretariats as follows:

SP 2-Sr 5 "Control by sampling" to Rumania

SP 10-Sr 1 "Measurement of the speed of vehicles" to the United Kingdom

SP 16-Sr 1 "Dosemeters" to the United Kingdom or USSR, to be decided by agreement between the two countries

SP 4 "Measurement of length, area, angle" to the United Kingdom.

The following Secretariats remain vacant in the absence of candidate States: SP 11 "Measurement of pressure", SP 19 "Measurement of characteristics of materials", SP 19-Sr 3 "Hardness (reference blocks and testing machines)".

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 7.2.b

The situation of SP 30-Sr 1

The Committee took note of information on the work of the Secretariat SP 30-Sr 1 "pH-metry et ionometry" and on the discrepancies between Recommendation R 54 and IUPAC recommendations. Since a meeting between OIML and IUPAC experts was planned the Committee decided to postpone the study of that matter to its next meeting.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 7.3
Adoption of International Recommendations

The Committee approved for immediate publication, and then presentation to the Ninth Conference for formal sanction, the following International Recommendations:

- Sound calibrators*
- Measuring instrumentation for human response to vibration*
- Pure-tone audiometers*
- Nonautomatic weighing instruments (R 76 revised).*

The approval of R 76 takes into account an amendment on electrostatic discharges notified during the meeting and applies to both parts of the Recommendation.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 8
Liaison with some International Institutions

The Committee took note of oral reports on the relations between OIML and various institutions: bodies of the Metre Convention, ISO and IEC (in particular, work of ISO/TAG 4 on vocabulary and uncertainties) and metrological European bodies.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 9
Developing countries

The Committee took note of a report on the organization by Germany and BIML of a training course on verification of weighing instruments for which the travel expenses of four trainees were paid from the OIML Development Council budget.

The Committee agreed that BIML participate again in a second similar course that Germany will organize in 1992 and that the travel expenses of two trainees be paid by OIML.

The Committee also took note of information on courses organized by Germany and Cuba.

Following a proposal from Cameroon, the Committee charged the Bureau with an inquiry to ascertain the actual needs of developing countries in the field of training.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 10
OIML seminars

The Committee took note of information on the preparations for a technical seminar on instruments for the measurement of air pollution, which will take place in Switzerland in 1992.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 11
Report on the activities of BIML (October 1990 - September 1991)

The Committee took note of the report of the activities of BIML for the period from October 1990 to September 1991.

DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 12
The election of a Vice-President of the Committee

The Committee elected as Vice-President: Prof. M. KOCHSIEK, Germany.

*DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 13
Preparations for the Ninth Conference*

The Committee took note of information on the preparations for the Ninth Conference in Greece and agreed in the proposed dates (first week of November 1992).

Furthermore the Committee took note of the proposals for the agenda for the Conference and for the budget for the years 1993 to 1996.

*DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 14.1
OIML Bulletin*

The Committee took note of information on the OIML Bulletin.

*DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 14.2
Instituting a world metrology day*

The Committee took note of a proposal from Rumania to organize a "World Metrology Day". The Committee considered that any decision on this matter was premature and invited its Members to consider ways in which metrology could be promoted at the national level.

*DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 14.3
Relations between OIML and the industry manufacturing measuring instruments*

The Committee took note of a letter from CECIP (European Committee of Manufacturers of Weighing Instruments).

The Committee expressed its appreciation of the intention of manufacturers who are members of CECIP to urge their national authorities to implement OIML Recommendations in national regulations quickly.

The Committee recalled that on several occasions it had requested its Members to associate manufacturers closely in the technical work of OIML, as clearly specified in the "Guide for CIML Members", and requested that the need for such participation be expressed in the future directives for the technical work of OIML.

The Committee then recalled that the OIML working policy clearly aims at issuing Recommendations worded in terms of metrological performances to be reached and test methods, but not in terms of design requirements which could impede innovation in the field.

*DECISION CIML 1991 – ITEM 15
Date and place of the next meeting*

The Committee decided that its Twenty-seventh meeting will take place in Greece, at the beginning of November 1992, on the occasion of the Ninth Conference.

The Committee also accepted the invitation from Germany to hold the Twenty-eighth meeting in Berlin in 1993.

ANNEX 1
RESULTS OF THE VOTES ON DRAFT RECOMMENDATIONS

- 1: Sound calibrators
2: Measuring instrumentation for human response to vibration
3: Pure-tone audiometers
4: Nonautomatic weighing instruments (R 76 revised).

Member States	1	2	3	4
Australia	Y	Y	Y	Y
Austria	A	A	A	Y
Belgium	Y	Y	Y	Y
Brazil	Y	Y	Y	Y
Bulgaria	Y	Y	Y	Y
Cameroon	Y	Y	Y	Y
Canada	Y	Y	Y	Y
R.P. of China	Y	Y	Y	Y
Cuba	Y	Y	Y	Y
Cyprus	Y	Y	Y	Y
Czechoslovakia	Y	Y	Y	Y
Denmark	Y	Y	Y	Y
Finland	Y	Y	Y	Y
France	Y	Y	Y	Y
Germany	Y	Y	Y	Y
Greece	Y	Y	Y	Y
Hungary	Y	Y	Y	Y
India	Y	Y	Y	Y
Indonesia	Y	Y	Y	Y
Ireland	A	A	A	Y
Italy	Y	Y	Y	Y
Japan	Y	A	Y	Y
Kenya	Y	Y	Y	Y
R. of Korea	Y	Y	Y	Y
P.D.R. of Korea	Y	Y	Y	Y
Monaco	Y	Y	Y	Y
Netherlands	Y	A	Y	Y
Norway	Y	Y	Y	Y
Poland	Y	Y	Y	Y
Portugal	Y	Y	Y	Y
Rumania	Y	Y	Y	Y
Saudi Arabia	Y	Y	Y	Y
Spain	Y	Y	Y	Y
Sweden	Y	Y	Y	A
Switzerland	Y	Y	Y	Y
Tanzania	Y	Y	Y	Y
United Kingdom	Y	Y	Y	Y
United States of America	A	A	A	Y
U.S.S.R.	Y	Y	Y	Y
Yugoslavia	Y	Y	Y	Y

Y = yes, A = abstention

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